

SOF IEO — Topic Deep-Dive: Reading Comprehension & Written Expression

For Ambar, Class III CBSE

PART 1: READING COMPREHENSION

1.1 What the passage looks like

IEO passages are 4–6 lines long, about familiar things: a pet, a market trip, a school event, a train journey. Five questions follow. Most answers are written straight in the passage; one or two need a little thinking.

1.2 The 4-step method

1. **Read the passage slowly, once.** Picture it like a cartoon in your head.
2. **Read the question and find the question word:** who? where? when? how many? why?
3. **Go back and put your finger on the line** that answers it. Never answer from memory alone.
4. **Match the option to the passage words** — the correct option usually repeats or slightly reword the passage.

1.3 The three kinds of questions

Kind	Example	How to solve
Fact (written in passage)	“How many biscuits?”	Point to the exact line.
Word meaning	“Which word means ‘covered with soft hair’?”	Reread the sentence with each option in place.
Thinking / inference	“Who most likely was the white-haired lady?”	Combine clues (going to Nani’s village + lady waving = Nani).

Trap: options that are TRUE in real life but NOT in the passage. If the passage says “two biscuits”, the answer is two — even if your squirrel at home eats three.

1.4 Moral / “what does the story teach us”

Pick the lesson the WHOLE story shows, not one detail. A boy who loses a race but keeps smiling teaches “never give up” — not “badges are precious”.

PART 2: WRITTEN EXPRESSION

2.1 A correct sentence needs three things

1. **Capital letter** at the start — and for names (Ravi, Delhi, India, Monday, Diwali) and the word “I”.
2. **Correct end mark** — see the table below.
3. **Words in sensible order.**

Sentence type	Example	End mark
Statement	Ravi plays football.	full stop (.)
Question	Where is my pencil?	question mark (?)
Exclamation	What a lovely day!	exclamation mark (!)
Command	Shut the window.	full stop (.)

Big trap: “How old is your brother” needs ?, but “How beautifully she dances” is an exclamation and needs !. Ask: is it really asking something?

2.2 Rearranging jumbled words

Method: find the **doer** (naming word) first, then the **action**, then the rest. - *school / to / walks / Riya* → **Riya** (doer) + **walks** (action) + **to school** → "Riya walks to school." - Check the winning option starts with a capital and ends with the right mark. - Reject orders that sound silly even if the words fit: "The match won our team." — a match cannot win a team.

2.3 Polite speech

The polite version almost always contains **please, may I, excuse me, thank you, or you are welcome.**

Rude	Polite
Give me water.	May I have some water, please?
Move aside.	Excuse me, may I pass, please?
Tell me the answer!	Excuse me madam, may I ask a question?

Reply to "Thank you" with "You are welcome." Greet by time of day: good morning / good evening; "good night" is only for bedtime.

2.4 Commas

Use commas to separate items in a list: "I bought apples, bananas and grapes." No comma before the first item or after "and".

3. Common traps

Trap	Beat it by
Answering from memory, not passage	Always point back to the line.
Real-life-true but passage-false options	Only the passage counts.
? vs ! on "What/How" sentences	Is it a real question?
Jumbled sentence with two "possible" orders	Pick the one that makes SENSE, with capital + end mark.
"Okay." as a polite reply	Polite replies use the magic words.

4. Key facts checklist

- Read passage once fully, then hunt each answer with your finger.
- Fact answers are written in the passage; inference answers combine clues.
- Capital letters: sentence start, names, places, days, festivals, "I".
- . statement/command, ? question, ! exclamation.
- Jumbled words: doer, then action, then the rest.
- Polite words: please, may I, excuse me, thank you, you are welcome.

5. Quick drill (10 questions)

Passage: "Golu the puppy dug a hole near the gate and buried his rubber bone. In the evening, he forgot the spot. He sniffed all round the garden until his nose led him to the gate. Golu dug fast, found his bone and wagged his tail with joy."

1. What did Golu bury? (a stick / a rubber bone / a biscuit / a ball)
2. Where did he bury it? (near the gate / under a tree / in a pot / behind the house)
3. What helped Golu find the spot? (his eyes / his ears / his nose / his paws)
4. "Wagged his tail with joy" shows Golu was _____. (angry / happy / sleepy / hungry)
5. What does the story show about Golu? (he gave up quickly / he kept trying till he found it / he lost his bone forever / he disliked bones)

6. Rearrange: books / Riya / her / packed (Riya packed her books. / Books her Riya packed. / Her Riya books packed. / Packed books Riya her.)
7. Which needs a question mark: "How far is the station" or "How tall that tree is"?
8. Which is polite? (Get my bag. / Please get my bag.)
9. Which is correct? ("i live in Pune." / "I live in Pune.")
10. Choose the correct commas: (I need a pen, a ruler and glue. / I need, a pen a ruler and glue.)

Answers: 1. a rubber bone 2. near the gate 3. his nose 4. happy 5. he kept trying till he found it 6. Riya packed her books. 7. "How far is the station?" 8. Please get my bag. 9. "I live in Pune." 10. I need a pen, a ruler and glue.